default. No provision was made in either the revised Budget of 2020–21 or the budget provisions of 2021–22 as this facility did not take off.

The last of the credit schemes was a Special Credit Facility for street vendors. Under this facility, loans of Rs 10,000 each were to be provided to 50 lakh street vendors, which would result in a flow of Rs 5000 crore to them. The scheme implemented as the PM Small Vendor Atmanirbhar Nidhi (SVANidhi) made disbursement of loans of Rs 1200 crore by the end of December 2020 to about 12 lakh street vendors. The scheme continued to perform lackadaisically. By August 2021, after about 15 months of its launch, banks could sanction only about 27 lakh applications for an amount of Rs 2696 crore.

There are about 7.5 crore MSMEs in India with over 90 per cent being microenterprises. Only about 50 lakh of MSMEs receive credit in some form from banks and non-banks. Total outstanding credit to MSEs, which RBI tracks as priority-sector loans, amounted to about Rs 15 lakh crore. Total growth of outstanding bank loans between April and September 2020 was negative at Rs 99,000 crore and turned positive only in November. This also meant that the credit disbursed under the scheme was more than offset by contraction of credit earlier provided. Clearly, there was no evidence of stock of credit to MSMEs going up despite this guarantee scheme in the first nine months of the pandemic year 2020–21. Credit flow to micro and small enterprises started showing some positive growth in 2021 and credit growth reached 9 per cent year on year in September 2021.

The government announced five measures amounting to Rs 1.295 lakh crore to make long-term investment in agriculture and allied infrastructure. A Rs 1 lakh crore Agri Infrastructure Fund to build farmgate infrastructure was the highlight of this bouquet of measures. Separately, for MSMEs, the government announced a Rs 50,000 crore ‘Fund of Funds’ (FOF). As part of the stimulus package, lifetime outlays were announced for two ongoing schemes: Matsya Sampada Yojana and the Viability Gap Funding Scheme.